

DH-ADOM Technical Specification v1.0

DevHeal Hierarchical Agent Development & Orchestration Model

Normative specification • Version 1.0.0 • 2026-10-06

1. Scope

DH-ADOM defines a repository-level operating model for governed AI-native software engineering, centered on Root, Feature, and bounded Specialist Agents and integrated with AI-SDLC and ADLC.

2. Normative hierarchy

Engineering Constitution → AI-SDLC → ADLC → Root Agent → Feature Agent → Specialist Agent → Implementation → Validation → Evidence → Handoff → Integration.

3. Conformance classes

Class	Definition	Example
Critical	Must be implemented and enforced.	Bounded delegation
High	Must be implemented and auditable.	AI-SDLC traceability
Recommended	Should be implemented or documented as equivalent.	Optional diagram format

4. Root Agent

The Root Agent owns global orchestration and must not become the implementation owner of every feature. It selects Feature Agents, authorizes delegation, reviews evidence, coordinates cross-feature changes, and maintains global state.

5. Feature Agent

A Feature Agent persistently owns a bounded domain, including requirements, design, implementation, tests, evidence, local state, risks, and handoff.

6. Specialist Agent

A Specialist Agent is task-scoped, bounded by a parent delegation contract, and expected to return structured evidence and handoff.

7. Delegation Contract

The contract must carry parent, child, task, scope, permissions, budget, lifetime, evidence requirements, and acceptance criteria.

8. Security invariants

- No self-escalation of permissions or autonomy.
- No uncontrolled recursive delegation.
- No silent cross-feature modification.
- No release without required evidence.
- No production action outside policy.

9. Lifecycle

All software artifacts follow AI-SDLC; all agents follow ADLC; DH-ADOM determines who owns and executes each lifecycle step.

10. Conformance

Conformance requires passing all CRITICAL requirements and providing reproducible evidence. See CONFORMANCE-REQUIREMENTS.md.